

THE SMILLEYS & SMILLEY INTERNATIONAL

Document 05 · Locked Canon · The Secondary Family, Their Empire & the Feud

Family motto: "The Smile Is Ours."

Who They Are

The Smilleys are **Chicago's Black royalty**. The Donohues are Southern old money: land, faith, legacy. The Smilleys are Northern new money turned old: **glamour, jazz, fashion, and velvet cruelty**. The Donohues build kingdoms. The Smilleys build **brands**.

They are the **second-wealthiest family in the world** and the Donohues' **fiercest rivals and competitors**. The two families have been at war since the **Savannah Betrayal of March 7, 1952** (see Document 03). In **January 2005**, the Smilleys move their headquarters from Chicago to Atlanta, into Donohue territory.

Item	Detail
Family fortune	About \$640 billion (second in the world)
Company	Smilley International, Inc. (privately held; family holds 100% of votes and 33.7% of the equity. Full share distribution in Document 13.)
Valuation	About \$1.9 trillion
Atlanta estate	Ravenhurst , 4 Ravenhurst Lane NW, Atlanta, GA 30327. A 1920s French château bought in 2004 on 90 acres just east of Belmont Crest's wall.
Chicago estate	Hart House , 4900 S. Greenwood Ave., Kenwood, Chicago (still owned; Odessa's favorite)

SMILLEY FAMILY TREE (Ages as of Monday, January 3, 2005)

- **Cornelius Smilley** (1908–1987) + **Odessa Hart Smilley** (84)
 - **Lucius Smilley** (55) + **Vivienne Beaumont Smilley** (49)
 - **Lucius "Luke" Smilley Jr.** (28) + **Noelle Smilley** (26)
 - **Delphine Smilley-Ashe** (25) + **Gideon Ashe** (29)
 - **Esther Smilley** (22)
 - **Emma Smilley** (2) and **Victoria Smilley** (2), secretly fathered by Marc-Anthony Bullock
 - **Desmond Smilley** (48), divorced
 - **Quentin Smilley** (21)
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THE FOUNDER

Cornelius Augustus Smilley (Deceased)

- **Born:** Saturday, August 8, 1908, Vicksburg, Mississippi · **Died:** Thursday, February 19, 1987, Chicago (aged 78)
 - Left Mississippi in 1925 during the Great Migration. Worked as a **Pullman porter from 1926 to 1937** and was a proud member of the Brotherhood of Sleeping Car Porters.
 - Pullman porters were forced to answer to "George" and to smile for tips. Cornelius smiled for eleven years. **The family name was originally "Smiley."** He added the second "L" in 1938 when he opened his first hotel: *"They made me smile for them. Now they'll pay to see me smile, and they'll spell it my way."*
 - A brilliant showman who treated **hotels as theater**. Doormen in white gloves, a jazz orchestra every night, and fresh roses in every room.
 - **His wound:** The Savannah Betrayal (1952). He died believing Alexander Donohue robbed him.
 - **Died** of a heart attack the day after the Donohue Chicago opened directly across from his flagship. The Smilleys call it murder by hotel.
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THE FAMILY

Odessa Hart Smilley — The Dowager Empress

- **Born:** January 24, 1920, Chicago (Bronzeville) · **Age:** 84 (turns 85 on Monday, January 24, 2005) · **Looks:** mid-60s
- A former torch singer at the Regal Theater and the Smilley Hotel's supper club, the Crystal Room. She married Cornelius in 1946. He was 37 and she was 26.
- **Simone Donohue's nemesis.** The two queens met exactly once, at a 1963 NAACP gala. Their 90-second conversation is still discussed in Chicago and Atlanta.
- She's convinced Simone holds proof of what really happened in Savannah. **She's right.**
- Named Esther's middle name ("Odessa"). **She suggested "Simone" as Victoria's middle name**, saying it was after "a French jazz singer I once loved." It was really a private dig at her rival. She has no idea the baby is Simone's great-great-granddaughter.
- **Voice:** Gravelly, grand, cruel. *"Simone Donohue has been ninety years old since 1950."*

Lucius Cornelius Smilley — The Chairman

- **Born:** November 30, 1949 · **Age:** 55 · **Looks:** early 40s
- Howard University '71, University of Chicago MBA '74. **Chairman & CEO of Smilley International (1987–present).**

- Charming, cultured, and vindictive. He grew Smilley International from \$40 billion to \$1.9 trillion. He has hated the Donohues since he was two years old, because he was raised to.
- **Moving the headquarters to Atlanta** is his life's crusade: *"Daddy died looking at their hotel. I'll die looking at their grave."*
- **Named Esther his heir** on her 21st birthday (**Saturday, September 20, 2003**) at the Smilley Harlem gala, passing over Luke and Delphine. Luke threw a champagne glass at the ice sculpture.
- **SECRET:** Lucius was diagnosed with **early-onset Parkinson's disease** in 2003. Only his neurologist and Vivienne know. It's why he rushed the succession, and he hides a tremor behind a cane he claims is "for style."
- **SECRET:** He has long suspected that Luke is not his biological son.
- **Voice:** Velvet baritone, literary, poisonous. *"We don't lose to the Donohues. We allow them to finish second, graciously, for now."*

Vivienne Beaumont Smilley — The Brand

- **Born:** March 17, 1955, Washington, D.C. (the Gold Coast neighborhood) · **Age:** 49 · **Looks:** mid-30s
- A former **Ebony Fashion Fair** runway model, and the first Black woman to front a major French perfume campaign (1976).
- **Chief Brand Officer, Smilley International.** She created the **Smile** fragrance, the **Odessa** couture line, and **Hart Home**.
- An icy perfectionist who loves her children in order of usefulness.
- **SECRET: Luke is Desmond's son.** It came from a two-month affair with her brother-in-law in the spring of 1975. Desmond knows. Lucius suspects. Luke has no idea.
- **Voice:** Cool, elegant, surgical. *"Darling, I don't dislike you. I simply don't see you."*

Desmond Hart Smilley — The Snake

- **Born:** August 21, 1956 · **Age:** 48 · **Looks:** late 30s
- Lucius's younger brother. **Vice Chairman, Smilley International.** He runs the real estate division, **Smilley Estates**.
- Divorced (twice). Father of Quentin. **Secretly Luke's biological father.**
- Has resented being the "spare" his whole life. He plans to use Luke's claim, and then reveal Luke's true paternity, to push Esther out and seize the company.
- **SECRET:** He is in secret talks with **Martin Olson**, an enemy inside the enemy's house. Their deal: help each other remove the two heirs, Esther and Marc-Anthony.
- **Voice:** Easy laugh, dead eyes. *"Family is everything. That's why I keep a copy of everyone's."*

Lucius "Luke" Smilley Jr. — The Dethroned Prince

- **Born:** February 2, 1976 · **Age:** 28 · **Looks:** mid-20s

- Eldest child. Morehouse '98 (the Smilleys chose Atlanta for college as a statement), Harvard MBA '02.
- **President, Smiley Hotels & Resorts.** He's genuinely good at hotels.
- He was raised as the heir until 2003, and has been **humiliated and furious** ever since.
- **Married:** Noelle Price, May 26, 2001. They've been through years of failed fertility treatments, which makes Esther's "IVF twins" feel like a daily insult.
- **Doesn't know Desmond is his biological father.**
- **Voice:** Loud, entitled, wounded. *"I did everything right. She did everything first."*

Noelle Price Smiley — The Social Climber

- **Born:** June 1, 1978, Milwaukee · **Age:** 26 · **Looks:** early 20s
- Former **Miss Black Wisconsin (1998)** and a Chicago TV weather anchor. Luke's wife.
- Desperate for a baby, a title, and a seat at the Belmont Crest Country Club. **She'd betray the Smilleys in a heartbeat for the Donohues' approval.**
- **Voice:** Sweet as pie and twice as fattening. *"I'm not jealous, I'm just paying attention."*

Delphine Smiley-Ashe — The Ice Queen

- **Born:** October 5, 1979 · **Age:** 25 · **Looks:** early 20s
- Middle child. Parsons School of Design '01. **President, Maison Smiley**, the luxury department stores and lifestyle brands.
- A fashion icon and a *Vogue* favorite, with a taste for elegant revenge. She hates Esther with style.
- **Married:** **Gideon Ashe**, June 21, 2003, at the Smiley Harlem.
- **Voice:** Clipped, bored, lethal. *"Esther got Daddy's company. I got his taste. We'll see which lasts."*

Gideon Ashe — The Gambler

- **Born:** July 18, 1975, New York · **Age:** 29 · **Looks:** mid-20s
- Founder of **Ashe Capital**, a hedge fund. He's handsome and smooth, and he's lying about everything.
- **SECRET:** The fund is collapsing, and Gideon owes **\$212 million** to underground high-stakes card games. **Those games are run by the Blackwater Syndicate.** Sovereign holds the Smiley son-in-law's marker, and Marc doesn't yet realize what leverage he has.
- **Voice:** Easy confidence, constant sweating. *"It's a liquidity event, not a problem."*

Esther Odessa Smiley — The Heiress

(Full profile in Document 02.)

- **Age: 22. Designated heir. President, Smilley International Atlanta.** She personally runs the move to Atlanta.
- **Her masterstroke:** In 2002 she began building a 72-story tower in Buckhead under a shell company called **Peachtree Pinnacle Partners**. Nobody knew who owned it until the December 2004 announcement. **It was the same trick Alexander Donohue used to buy Belmont Crest in 1955.** Victor noticed. Simone laughed out loud.
- **Mother of Emma and Victoria** ("the IVF twins").

Quentin Hart Smilley — The Wild Card

- **Born:** November 11, 1983 · **Age:** 21 · **Looks:** late teens
- Desmond's only child. He dropped out of Northwestern and is a DJ and club promoter who plans to "go to Atlanta and run the city."
- **Alvin Donohue's new best friend** in the club scene. **Mallory Olson's forbidden attraction.** He's sweeter than he pretends to be, and far less stupid.
- He has no idea he's his father's pawn.
- **Voice:** Charming, clowning, and secretly lonely. *"I'm not the black sheep. I'm the sheep that brought the party."*

Emma & Victoria Smilley — "The IVF Twins"

(Full profiles in Document 02.) Both are 2. Their nanny is **Beatrix Pennington** (Document 07). The Smilleys adore them. Their grandfather Lucius calls them "my dividends." **Nobody in the family knows whose they are.**

THE HISTORY OF SMILLEY INTERNATIONAL

Year	Milestone
1938	Cornelius opens The Smilley , a 90-room hotel on South Parkway in Bronzeville, with the Crystal Room supper club. Nat King Cole, Billie Holiday, and Count Basie perform there.
1941–1951	Green Book expansion across the North and Midwest: The Smilley Harlem (1946), Detroit, Cleveland, St. Louis, Kansas City, and Pittsburgh. Plus a lakeside resort at Idlewild, Michigan , the "Black Eden."
March 7, 1952	The Savannah Betrayal. The Donohue-Smilley merger collapses.
1953–1960	Smilley Realty is founded. During the era of predatory "contract buying," it builds and finances fair-mortgage apartment buildings for Black Chicagoans, and becomes Chicago's largest Black landlord.
1962	Smilley Resorts opens at Oak Bluffs, Martha's Vineyard and in Montego Bay, Jamaica .
1968	South Parkway is renamed Martin Luther King Drive. Cornelius keeps the flagship's lights on for 30 straight days in mourning.

Year	Milestone
1974–1979	Smilley Resorts expands to Barbados, Nassau, and the Riviera. The Smilley at Lake Shore , a 60-story luxury condominium tower, opens on Chicago's Gold Coast in 1979.
1983	Maison Smilley , the first Black-owned luxury department store on the Magnificent Mile, opens at 900 N. Michigan Avenue.
Wednesday, February 18, 1987	Donohue Chicago opens directly across from The Smilley.
Thursday, February 19, 1987	Cornelius dies of a heart attack the next morning. Lucius, 37, becomes Chairman & CEO.
1989	The company is renamed Smilley International, Inc. , and goes global with hotels in London (Mayfair), Paris, Dubai, and Monaco.
1990s	Lifestyle brands: Smile fragrance (1991), <i>Odessa</i> couture (1994), Hart Home (1997). Maison Smilley flagships open in New York, Beverly Hills, London, Paris, and Tokyo.
2001	Smilley Estates builds branded luxury residences in 20 cities.
September 20, 2003	Esther is named heir.
2002–2004	"Peachtree Pinnacle Partners" secretly builds a 72-story tower in Buckhead.
Thursday, December 9, 2004	The Announcement: Smilley International will move its world headquarters to Smilley Tower, 3434 Peachtree Road NE, Atlanta, GA 30326 , directly across Peachtree Road from Donohue Tower.
Monday, January 3, 2005	Smilley Tower officially opens on the morning of the series premiere.

Smilley International — Structure (2005)

Division	Business	Leader
Smilley Hotels & Resorts	1,400 luxury hotels and resorts in 90 countries. Brands: The Smilley, Crystal Room Hotels, Idlewild Resorts.	Luke Smilley
Smilley Estates	Luxury real estate, branded residences, commercial towers	Desmond Smilley
Maison Smilley	Luxury department stores (48 flagships), high-end retail	Delphine Smilley-Ashe
Smilley Lifestyle	Smile fragrance, <i>Odessa</i> couture, Hart Home, cosmetics, jewelry	Vivienne Smilley
Smilley Private Clubs	Members-only clubs in 20 cities	Lucius (direct)
Smilley International Atlanta	The new headquarters operation and the Southern expansion	Esther Smilley

- **Employees:** About 610,000 · **Countries:** 90 · **Flagship:** The Smilley, Chicago · **HQ (2005):** Smilley Tower, Atlanta
- **The Smilley Fund:** The family charity. It's generous, but **always with a press release**, a pointed contrast with the Donohues' "spare no expense, sign no name."

THE FEUD — Rules of Engagement

1. **Every Donohue opening gets a Smilley counter-opening**, usually within the same month.
 2. **Neither family has attended the other's funeral since 1952.**
 3. Hospitality is the main battlefield: Donohue Hotels & Resorts (a DGH division) vs. Smilley Hotels & Resorts. Natasha vs. Luke. Natasha vs. Esther.
 4. **2005 battlegrounds:**
 - The **Atlanta skyline** (the rival towers)
 - The **Belmont Crest Country Club** (Noelle wants in)
 - **Harmony's brokerage** (Esther steers Smilley deals to her best friend)
 - **The Olympic-sized fight over the "Auburn Avenue Revival" redevelopment bid.** Whoever wins it rebuilds the street where Alexander started.
 5. **Hidden alliances:** Martin + Desmond. Noelle + anyone. Gideon and his debt to Blackwater. Mallory + Quentin.
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Smilley Secrets Ledger

Secret	Who Knows
The twins are Marc-Anthony Bullock's	Esther only
Luke is Desmond's son	Vivienne, Desmond. Lucius suspects.
Lucius has Parkinson's	Lucius, Vivienne
Desmond is allied with Martin Olson	Desmond, Martin
Gideon owes \$212M to Blackwater games	Gideon, the Blackwater Syndicate
Odessa's "Simone" middle-name dig	Odessa
The Savannah Letter exists	Simone has it. Odessa suspects it.